

August

21



1961

Kenyan freedom leader

After nine years in prison, Jomo Kenyata was released by British authorities. The leader of the Kenyan independence movement, he was instrumental in freeing his country from British rule.

Also on this day

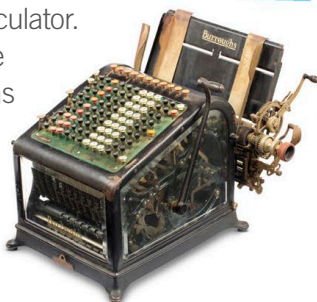
1968 The Prague Spring in Czechoslovakia (present-day Czechia) – a series of mass demonstrations for political reform – came to an end when Soviet forces invaded and took back control.

1986 Lake Nyos in Cameroon suddenly released a dense gas cloud of carbon dioxide, known as a limnic eruption, suffocating people and farm animals in nearby villages.

2018 Scientists confirmed that the Indian spacecraft *Chandrayaan-1* had detected the first water ice on the Moon.

Calculating machine

US inventor William S Burroughs patented the first successful calculator. Although adding machines were already available, this device was more accurate, consistently giving correct answers.

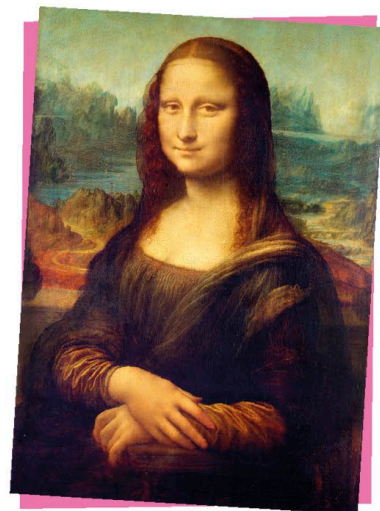


1888

Missing Mona Lisa

1911

The world-famous painting by Renaissance artist Leonardo da Vinci was stolen from the Louvre Museum in Paris, France. Spanish artist Pablo Picasso was suspected after he was found buying items stolen from the museum. He was later cleared of the charges.



Born this day

1986 Usain Bolt, Jamaican athlete. He is considered one of the greatest sprinters of all time, winning numerous Olympic gold medals in the 100 m and 200 m events.